Women's Specialists of Clear Lake
Geffrey H. Klein, MD · FACOG · DABOM

400 W Medical Center Blvd, Suite 300
Webster, Texas 77598 · (281) 557-0300

Understanding Menopause

A natural life transition — what to expect and how to thrive through it

WHAT IS MENOPAUSE?

Perimenopause
Transition phase (2–10 years); irregular periods; begins in 40s; estrogen fluctuates

Menopause
Official diagnosis: **12 consecutive months without a period**; average age 51

Postmenopause
All years after menopause; symptoms may persist; bone/heart health becomes priority

Premature Menopause
Before age 40; requires evaluation; increased health risks; treatment strongly recommended

COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Hot flashes
- Night sweats
- Insomnia
- Mood changes
- Brain fog
- Vaginal dryness
- Decreased libido
- Weight gain
- Hair thinning
- Joint pain

Symptom severity varies widely. Many women have mild symptoms; others find them significantly disruptive. Treatment is available and effective.

LONG-TERM HEALTH RISKS

Increased Risk After Menopause:

- Osteoporosis (bone loss) — get DEXA scan
- Heart disease — leading cause of death in women
- Cognitive decline / dementia risk
- Urinary incontinence / UTIs
- GSM (Genitourinary Syndrome of Menopause)

Preventive Measures:

- Annual mammogram; bone density screening
- Regular cardiovascular exercise
- Calcium 1200mg/day + Vitamin D 600–800 IU

HORMONE REPLACEMENT THERAPY (HRT)

HRT is the **most effective treatment for menopausal symptoms**. Modern HRT options are well-studied and safe for most women. Discuss your individual risk profile with Dr. Klein.

Estrogen Therapy (ET)
For women who have had a hysterectomy. Best symptom control for hot flashes, vaginal dryness, and bone protection.

Combined HRT (EPT)
Estrogen + progesterone for women with intact uterus. Progestogen protects the uterine lining.

Local / Vaginal Therapy
Low-dose vaginal estrogen cream, ring, or tablet for GSM (dryness, pain, UTIs) with minimal systemic absorption.

HRT May Not Be Recommended If You Have:

- History of breast cancer
- Blood clots (DVT/PE)
- Undiagnosed vaginal bleeding
- Active liver disease

NON-HORMONAL OPTIONS

Fezolinetant (Veozah): Non-hormonal FDA-approved for hot flashes — blocks NK3 receptor

SSRIs/SNRIs: Paroxetine, venlafaxine — FDA-approved for hot flash reduction

Lifestyle: Regular aerobic exercise, cool sleeping environment, stress reduction

Diet: Phytoestrogens (soy, flaxseed), calcium-rich foods, limiting caffeine/alcohol

Menopause Is Not an Ending — It's a New Beginning

Modern medicine offers excellent options to manage symptoms and protect your long-term health. Dr. Klein will personalize a treatment plan that fits your health history, symptoms, and goals. Don't suffer in silence — call
(281) 557-0300
to discuss your options.